

KvK CASTLE BATTLE

MASTER STRATEGY GUIDE v5

Built around two core pillars:

PILLAR I

PILLAR II

Everything else — heroes, formations, positions, garrison ops, healing — exists to support one of these two pillars.

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Game Basics, Win Condition, Backup Roster & Team Structure

Every player must understand the scoring system, turret mechanics, their role, and who covers them if they are absent.

The Objective & Win Condition Choice

Castle Battles run every **4th Saturday at 12:00 UTC**. The winner is the alliance with the most total castle occupation time. Reaching **2.5 hours of continuous occupation** wins instantly.

R5 must choose a win condition approach before the battle starts:

- **Pursue instant win:** Hold continuously, reach 2.5 hours as fast as possible. Best when your alliance is clearly dominant. R5 signals all leaders when approaching 2 hours to hold at all costs.
- **Maximize total server points:** Voluntarily yield the castle briefly near the 2-hour mark so other alliances participate, extending the event and generating more KvK points for everyone. R5 calls the voluntary yield timing.

The Turret Bonus & Turret Sequencing Rule

Turrets held by your kingdom grant a lethality bonus to every troop inside your castle.

Turrets Held	Lethality Bonus	Impact
1	+8%	Minimum target — always take at least one
2	+12%	Significant damage increase
3	+15%	Strong advantage
4	+20%	Maximum bonus — decisive edge

Turret sequencing: Turrets are captured **after** the castle is secured. The moment Yensid calls 'castle held' in voice, every leader NOT assigned to Yensid's garrison and NOT in Group 2 immediately redirects to their assigned turret. If a turret has more than 4 defenders, use a **double rally** on it.

RULE: Turret priority order: East (Pentode) → South (Pikachu) → West (Brumbar) → North (Marco). Start with the nearest turret to get +8% lethality active as fast as possible. Group 2 does NOT attack turrets — they remain staged for counter-rally duty.

Backup Roster — Every Role Needs a Backup

One absent named player can collapse the entire strategy. Every role must have a confirmed backup assigned before the event.

Role	Primary	Backup	Pre-Battle Check
Castle garrison leader	Yensid	— fill in —	Adjacent to castle. Pre-rally screen ready.
Wave 1 leader	Pentode	— fill in —	Staging position confirmed. March time measured.
Wave 1 leader	Pikachu	— fill in —	Staging position confirmed. March time measured.
Group 2 counter lead	Nick	— fill in —	Second alliance joined. Counter-rally staged.
Group 2 counter	Admiral	— fill in —	Second alliance joined. Counter-rally staged.
Group 2 counter	Lord Minion	— fill in —	Second alliance joined. Counter-rally staged.

Role	Primary	Backup	Pre-Battle Check
Wave 3 / Turret West	Brumbar	— fill in —	Turret assignment confirmed.
Wave 3 / Turret North	Marco	— fill in —	Turret assignment confirmed.
Wave 3 support	WiFi	— fill in —	Staging position confirmed.

BACKUP RULE: Backups must be at their assigned map position and on the pre-rally screen from the battle start — not just on standby. If the primary fails to launch, the backup fires immediately without waiting for a voice call.

Pre-Battle Intelligence Protocol

Formation choices (60/40/0 vs 60/20/20) depend on knowing the enemy's troop composition. Without scouting, all formation decisions are guesswork.

- Assign one R4 as the **opening scout** before the battle clock starts.
- At **T+0:00**, the scout immediately solo-attacks the castle with a march speed boost.
- Read the **battle report** — note the garrison hero, troop ratio, and approximate troop count.
- Report in voice: "**60/40/0 — heavy cavalry**" or "**60/20/20 — mixed**". R4 calls the formation.
- **Default if no report:** always use 60/20/20.

Team Roles

Role	Who	Core Duty	R4 Voice Call
R5 / Commander	Alliance leader	Win condition, target calls, alliance switches	— overall command —
R4 Officers	One per wave group	Formation, countdowns, garrison audits	'5-4-3-2-1 — Wave X go'
Wave Rally Leaders	Named in Ch 2	Open rallies on exact time; pre-rally screen	'Wave leaders — LAUNCH'
Group 2 Counter	Named in Ch 6	Join second alliance on castle capture; stage counter	'Group 2 — release now'
Rally Fillers	All assigned members	Join rallies instantly, correct hero and formation	'Fill your rally NOW'
Scout	One designated R4	Solo-attack at T+0, report enemy formation in voice	'Formation: 60/20/20'
Solo Attackers	Anyone not in a rally	Non-stop pressure on enemy castle at all times	'Everyone solo attack'

WARNING: Every rally **MUST** have 8-9 active fillers to be full. Use Sheet 4 of the Calculators workbook to track fill counts in real time.

PART I — THE WAVE STRATEGY

Continuous multi-wave pressure that defeats two alliances simultaneously

CHAPTER 1

How the Wave Strategy Works

The Wave Strategy is the alliance's **primary offensive doctrine**. Instead of committing every rally at once — which hands the enemy a 5-minute window to counter — we launch staggered waves so they arrive within seconds of each other, creating relentless pressure that is almost impossible to answer.

The Wave Funnel — Positioning Drives Timing

The 15-second launch stagger only works if march times are calibrated. **If all leaders are adjacent, waves arrive 15 seconds apart — far too spread out.** The correct solution is a funnel: earlier waves stand further back so their longer march time offsets their earlier launch, causing all waves to arrive close together.

Wave	Launch	Target Tile Distance	March Time Goal	Net Arrival
Wave 1	T + 0:00	1-2 tiles from castle	~2 sec	T + 0:02
Wave 2	T + 0:15	4-6 tiles from castle	~13 sec	T + 0:28
Wave 3	T + 0:30	7-10 tiles from castle	~27 sec	T + 0:57

All three waves arrive within **30-60 seconds** of each other — creating a pressure wall rather than three isolated attacks. Use **Sheet 1 of the Calculators workbook** to enter each leader's personal march time and calculate exact launch offsets.

Wave Timeline

TIME	EVENT	EFFECT
T + 0:00	Wave 1 launches — strongest leaders hit the castle	Enemy garrison absorbs full force
T + 0:15	Wave 2 launches — counter any retake attempt	Enemy counter-rally is blocked mid-flight
T + 0:30	Wave 3 launches — flood castle with fresh troops	Castle refilled before enemy can react
T + 5:00	Next wave cycle begins (5-min cooldown)	Enemy has had no rest for the entire window

The 5-Minute Gap — Between Wave Cycles

The 5-minute rally cooldown is the wave strategy's only vulnerability. During this window:

- **All non-leader players** solo attack in rotating groups of 3-4 so the enemy garrison never gets a quiet moment to reinforce.
- **Wave leaders** immediately start batch healing the moment their rally returns.
- **Hard rule:** no second wave cycle launches unless each rally has at least 60% fill confirmed by R4.

5-MIN RULE: R4 calls 'Everyone solo attack' immediately after each wave exchange and holds it until the next cycle is confirmed ready.

Minimum Fill Threshold

A rally with fewer than **6 confirmed fillers** should NOT launch against a defended castle.

- If a wave is underfilled, the rally leader holds and the wave cycle is skipped.
- Replace that wave with intensified solo pressure until fillers are available.
- R4 checks fill count on **Sheet 4 of the Calculators workbook** before calling every launch.

Why It Beats Two Enemy Alliances

- **Enemy Alliance X** launches a counter — Wave 2 is already in the air to intercept.
- **Enemy Alliance Y** tries to coordinate — Wave 3 arrives before they can synchronize.
- If the enemy **does kick us out**, our next wave is seconds from landing.
- Each wave carries **fresh, fully-healed troops** — no degradation across the pressure chain.

Non-Stop Pressure Rule

ABSOLUTE RULE: If you are NOT in one of the three main wave groups and the enemy holds the castle — send solo attacks non-stop. Never let the enemy rest, heal, swap heroes, or plan freely.

Scaling the Wave System

Wave Count	Leaders Needed	Fillers Required	Covers Against
3 waves (standard)	9	72 - 81	2 enemy alliances
4 waves	12	96 - 108	3 enemy alliances
5 waves (max)	15	120 - 135	4+ enemy alliances

Wave Roles & Team Assignments

Each wave has a designated team. Leaders are assigned by power level — the strongest hit first.

Wave Team Structure

Wave	Leaders	Launch	Primary Role
Wave 1 (Strongest)	Pentode Pikachu Yensid	T + 0:00	Capture the castle — maximum force first strike
Wave 2 (Counter)	Nick Admiral Lord Minion	T + 0:15	Hit anyone trying to retake; refill the castle
Wave 3 (Support)	Brumbar Marco WiFi	T + 0:30	Flood castle with fully-healed fresh troops

Post-Castle Turret Assignments

Once the castle is secured, Wave 1 and Wave 3 leaders redirect to turrets. **Yensid stays in the castle garrison. Group 2 stays staged for counter-rally duty.**

Objective	Rally Leader	Post-Castle Timing	Notes
King's Castle	Yensid (stays)	Hold from Wave 1 capture	Garrison leader — does not attack turrets
East Turret	Pentode	Immediately after castle secured	Double rally if strongly garrisoned
South Turret	Pikachu	Immediately after castle secured	Double rally if strongly garrisoned
West Turret	Brumbar	Immediately after castle secured	Double rally if strongly garrisoned
North Turret	Marco	Immediately after castle secured	Double rally if strongly garrisoned

NOTE: Turret leaders and castle wave leaders are the same players — but the turret task is sequential, not simultaneous. Wave duties come first. Turret duties begin only after Yensid confirms the castle is held.

R4 Communication Callers

Each wave group has one designated R4 caller. That R4 watches server time and calls the countdown only for their group — preventing voice overlap.

Group	Rally Leaders	Designated R4 Caller	Countdown Call
Wave 1	Pentode, Pikachu, Yensid	— assign R4 —	'5-4-3-2-1 — Wave 1 go'
Wave 2 / Group 2	Nick, Admiral, Lord Minion	— assign R4 —	'5-4-3-2-1 — Wave 2 go' / 'Group 2 release'
Wave 3 / Turrets	Brumbar, Marco, WiFi	— assign R4 —	'5-4-3-2-1 — Wave 3 go' / 'Turrets launch'

Positions & Timed Pre-Wave Setup

Positioning is the silent multiplier of the Wave Strategy. Position drives march time, and march time drives whether the wave funnel works.

Wave Funnel Positioning

Wave	Position	Distance from Castle	Why
Wave 1	Adjacent — directly next to castle	1-2 tiles	Shortest march = arrives first even after Wave 2 and 3 launch
Wave 2	Medium distance	4-6 tiles	Longer march offsets the 15-sec later launch — arrives close behind Wave 1
Wave 3	Further back	7-10 tiles	Even longer march offsets the 30-sec later launch — arrives close behind Wave 2

Result: all three waves arrive within **30-60 seconds** of each other regardless of launch stagger. The enemy faces a sustained pressure wall, not three isolated attacks with recovery windows between them.

CRITICAL: Do not move from your assigned position unless R4 or R5 explicitly instructs you. Even 2 extra tiles of march time can break the wave funnel synchronization.

Timed Pre-Battle Countdown

The old checklist was too vague. Here is the exact countdown every leader follows:

Time Before Battle	Action Required	Confirmed By
T - 30 minutes	Confirm hero lineup and formation for your role. Heroes set, formation selected.	Player self-check
T - 15 minutes	Move to your assigned map tile. Verify you are at the correct distance from the castle.	R4 visual check
T - 5 minutes	Open pre-rally screen. Configure troops and heroes. Stay on the Start Rally screen.	R4 calls 'pre-rally now'
T - 0 (battle start)	R4 confirms all wave leaders are on pre-rally screen before calling Wave 1 launch. Scout solo-attacks immediately.	R4 verbal confirm
T + 0:00	Wave 1 R4 calls '5-4-3-2-1 — Wave 1 go'. Wave 1 leaders launch.	R4 countdown call
T + 0:15	Wave 2 R4 calls '5-4-3-2-1 — Wave 2 go'. Wave 2 leaders launch.	R4 countdown call
T + 0:30	Wave 3 R4 calls '5-4-3-2-1 — Wave 3 go'. Wave 3 leaders launch.	R4 countdown call

GATE RULE: R4 MUST NOT call Wave 1 launch until every Wave 1 leader has verbally confirmed 'ready' on voice. One unready leader breaks the entire first strike.

This chapter covers hero and formation choices for Wave attacks. Defense configurations are in Chapter 9.

Troop Tier Requirement

CRITICAL: Troop tier is the single most important attack variable — more important than hero choice or formation. T5 troops deal significantly more damage and have more health per unit than T4. A perfectly composed T4 rally will almost always lose to a T5 garrison regardless of formation. If you only have T3 troops or below, your role is solo pressure — NOT rally joining.

Troop Tier	Role in This Strategy	Minimum Requirement
T5	Rally leader and primary filler — essential for Wave 1	Strongly recommended for Wave 1 leaders
T4	Rally filler — acceptable contribution	Minimum tier for joining any castle rally
T3 and below	Solo attacks only	Do NOT join castle rallies — costs a filler slot without meaningful combat power

Rally Leader Hero Priority Order

These heroes are NOT interchangeable. Use this priority order:

1. **Amadeus** — strongest universal attack buff. First choice for rally leader if available.
2. **Long Fei** — best choice if your formation is infantry-heavy (50/10/40).
3. **Petra or Thrud** — use whichever has more talent tree investment completed.
4. **Rosa** — strong fallback if the above heroes are not available.
5. **Rule:** if none of the above apply, use your single **highest-power hero with attack talents unlocked**, regardless of name. Hero power matters more than hero identity.

The First-4 Joiner Rule

CRITICAL: Only the first FOUR heroes to join a rally or garrison impact its core combat statistics. Heroes 5-8 contribute troops but have ZERO stat effect.

Attack Joiner Configuration

Slot	Hero	Why
Joiner #1	Chenko	Top attack buff for rally strikes
Joiner #2	Chenko	Stack the attack buff
Joiner #3	Amane	Secondary attack amplifier
Joiner #4	Amane	Completes the optimal offensive first-4
Joiners #5-8	Any strong T4/T5 contributors	Troop count only — no stat effect

Attack Formation Reference

Formation	Ratio (Inf/Cav/Arch)	When to Use
Standard Attack	50 / 20 / 30	Default — good vs mixed defenses. Use this if scouting is unavailable.
Heavy Archer Wing	50 / 10 / 40	When enemy garrison is heavy cavalry — confirmed by scout report
Key rule	Always match rally leader	Joiners must mirror the rally leader's ratio exactly

Post-Capture Hero Switch Sequence

Immediately after the castle is captured, the garrison must switch from attack heroes to defense heroes. Group 2 may be pre-staged with a counter-rally as early as 20 seconds after capture. The switch must happen **within 5 seconds** of capture confirmation.

1. Yensid calls 'castle held' in voice.
2. Yensid **immediately dispatches defense troops** using the Synchronization Swap method (Chapter 9).
3. Group 2 R4 simultaneously watches for any incoming enemy rally.
4. Turret leaders (Pentode, Pikachu, Brumbar, Marco) immediately redirect to their turret assignments.

TIMING: Do not delay the defense switch. Attack heroes in the garrison after capture is one of the most common causes of immediately losing the castle back to the enemy.

Double Rallies & Timing Execution

A Double Rally means two or more rallies arriving at the castle at the exact same second. This overwhelms the garrison before defenders can reinforce — no gap to refill.

Where to Find Server Time

SERVER TIME: The in-game server clock is visible in the top-left corner of the pre-rally screen, displayed as UTC HH:MM:SS. This is the **ONLY** clock to use for rally coordination. Never use your device clock — device clocks can be off by 2-10 seconds due to regional drift, which is enough to break synchronized launches.

How to Measure Your March Time

Before the battle starts, every rally leader must measure their personal march time:

1. From your assigned staging position, send a **solo attack** at the castle (or a nearby tile at similar distance).
2. Read your **march time from the battle report**.
3. Enter this number in **Sheet 1 of the Calculators workbook**. The sheet calculates your exact launch time.
4. When R4 calls a target arrival time (e.g. 'arrive at 12:00:30'), count back your march time to find your personal launch second.

Step-by-Step Double Rally Execution

Step	Action	Why It Matters
1 - R4 calls the time	A specific arrival time (e.g. 12:00:30) is posted in Discord or group chat	Everyone uses the same reference
2 - Enter pre-rally early	Open the rally interface immediately. Configure troops and heroes NOW — not at the last second.	No scrambling at the deadline
3 - Stage on Start screen	Stay on the final Start Rally screen, monitoring the in-game UTC server clock	One tap launches at the exact moment
4 - Calculate your launch time	Subtract your personal march time from the target arrival time. That is your launch second.	Simultaneous arrival, not simultaneous launch
5 - Launch at your personal time	Press Start Rally at your calculated launch second	A 3-second arrival gap is enough for the enemy to refill

REMINDER: Practice the pre-rally screen workflow before the battle. Leaders who hesitate at steps 3-5 miss the window and break the entire wave timing chain.

PART II — THE COUNTER STRATEGY

React, absorb and reclaim — never let the enemy hold the castle for long

CHAPTER 6

Counter-Rally Mechanics

The Counter Strategy is the alliance's **primary defensive doctrine**. When the enemy threatens the castle, we do not wait for a full 5-minute rally cycle. A second alliance tag — Group 2 — is pre-staged and ready to launch a counter-rally that reclaims the castle within seconds of the enemy taking it.

Why Two Alliance Tags

You **cannot rally your own castle** while your alliance holds it. Group 2 moves to a second alliance the moment the castle is captured, giving them an external tag to launch from. **Alliance switching is free in this game — no cooldown timer applies**. Group 2 can move immediately after castle capture and return after the battle.

The Counter-Rally Decision Tree

Enemy Action	Our Response
Enemy starts a rally on the castle	Group 2 R4 notes the enemy march time. Group 2 leaders remain staged on pre-rally screen. DO NOT launch yet.
Enemy rally FAILS to take the castle	Group 2 cancels their counter immediately. Alliance A keeps the castle. Enemy wasted their rally cycle.
Enemy rally SUCCEEDS — A is displaced	Group 2 releases their counter-rally. It was pre-staged and lands within seconds of the enemy taking control.
Group 2 holds the castle briefly	All Group 1 members solo attack the castle continuously. Group 2 R4 monitors Group 1 rally leader's march timer.
Group 1 rally leader is seconds away	Group 2 R4 calls 'WITHDRAW NOW'. Group 2 fully pulls ALL troops simultaneously. Castle is handed to Group 1.
Group 1 regains the castle	Occupation time resumes under Group 1 — the primary scoring tag. Group 2 immediately re-stages for the next counter.

CRITICAL WARNING: Group 2 MUST NOT arrive before the enemy rally. If Group 2 lands first, it becomes a same-kingdom fight and the enemy gets a free win. Always account for march speed in the delay calculation.

Counter Delay Formula

Group 2 launch delay = **Enemy march time + Battle duration + Safety buffer – Group 2 march time**

Example: enemy marches 20 sec + battle lasts 4 sec + 2 sec buffer – Group 2 marches 10 sec = **16 seconds after enemy launches**

Use **Sheet 2 of the Calculators workbook** to calculate this before every battle. Pre-calculate multiple scenarios (enemy close, enemy far) so R4 has the number ready instantly.

The Handback Operation — High Risk, Requires Practice

The handback of the castle from Group 2 to Group 1 is the **most difficult operation in this strategy**. It has a 2-3 second window and enemy players will actively try to snipe the castle during the gap.

1. R4 monitors Group 1 rally leader's march timer and calls **"Withdraw in 10 seconds"** in voice.
2. Group 2 pulls **ALL troops simultaneously** on that call — not one at a time.
3. Group 1 solo attackers are already poised — they immediately solo-enter the castle during the transition to block any snipe.
4. R4 confirms **"Group 1 in castle"** before Group 2 re-stages for the next cycle.

NOTE: Practice the handback operation in a non-KvK castle battle first. It is an expert operation that fails regularly even with experienced players. Label it as high risk in all briefings.

The Group 2 Doctrine — Pre-Positioned Counter

This is the core innovation of the Counter Strategy. Group 2 moves to a second alliance **the moment Wave 1 captures the castle** — not reactively after losing it. They sit ready, watching the enemy, counter-rally pre-staged. The response time drops from 5 minutes to under 30 seconds.

Setup — Immediately After Castle Capture

When Yensid calls 'castle held':

- **Yensid** stays in the castle and immediately switches to defense heroes.
- **Group 2** (Nick, Admiral, Lord Minion) immediately switches to the second alliance.
- Group 2 **pre-assigned fillers** (25-30 designated players) switch with them.
- Group 2 fills their rallies and stays on the pre-rally screen, watching for enemy activity.
- **Turret leaders** (Pentode, Pikachu, Brumbar, Marco) redirect to their turret assignments.
- Group 3 / Wave 3 (Brumbar, Marco, WiFi) handle turrets after completing their wave duties.

FILLER POOL RULE: Group 2 fillers must be pre-designated before the battle. Approximately 25-30 players should be assigned as Group 2 fillers and told to switch alliances at the same time as Group 2 leaders. This eliminates the chaos of asking people to move alliances mid-battle.

Why This Eliminates the 5-Minute Problem

Scenario	Without Group 2 Doctrine	With Group 2 Doctrine
Enemy takes castle	Wait full 5 minutes for new rally cycle to start	Counter launches within seconds — pre-staged
Enemy occupation time	Up to 5+ minutes per successful attack	20-40 seconds per successful attack
Enemy can reinforce?	Yes — 5 min is enough to set heroes and fill garrison	No — barely time to orient before counter arrives
Net occupation time lost	Significant per takeover	Minimal — near-instant recapture

Reset and Re-Stage After Handback

After every counter-rally cycle, Group 2 must be re-staged within **90 seconds** for the next enemy attempt:

1. Group 2 leaders and fillers batch heal immediately after returning the castle.
2. Reload troops. Return to pre-rally screen.
3. Target time to be fully re-staged: under 90 seconds.
4. If re-staging takes longer, **Group 3 (Brumbar, Marco, WiFi)** serves as emergency counter while Group 2 heals.

Plan B — Full Multi-Alliance Pivot

Plan B activates when the Group 2 Doctrine alone cannot hold. It involves a full command restructure and simultaneous two-tag assault. **Plan B is a last resort.** The Group 2 Doctrine should resolve most enemy attacks.

Plan B Trigger Conditions — Specific and Objective

R5 calls Plan B if **any two** of the following conditions are true:

- The enemy has successfully taken the castle **3 or more times** within a single 10-minute window.
- Group 2 held the castle after a counter but **lost it again within 60 seconds** of the handback.
- Two or more enemy alliances are launching **simultaneous double rallies** that Group 2 cannot match.

GATE: Do not call Plan B based on feeling. Only call it when the numerical conditions above are met. Premature Plan B activation wastes reorganization time and confuses filler players.

Leadership Redistribution

Unit	Leaders	Action
External Strike Force	Nick + Brumbar	Remain in (or commit fully to) the secondary alliance. Now lead the main offensive effort from the outside tag.
Garrison Command	Lord Minion	Assumes full command of all turret operations to maintain lethality bonuses while main force reorganizes.
Volunteer Pool	All unassigned members	Join the secondary alliance under Nick and Brumbar to maximize rally fill and strength.

Simultaneous Two-Tag Strike

Both alliance tags launch their rallies to arrive at the exact same second — a Double Rally from two separate tags. The castle garrison cannot be reinforced from two different sources simultaneously.

Plan B Exit — Return to Plan A

Once the castle has been held under the Plan B structure for at least **3 continuous minutes**, R5 calls 'Return to Plan A':

- Nick and Brumbar return to the main alliance.
- Volunteer fillers return.
- Group 2 re-stages in its normal pre-positioned counter role.
- **Do not return during an active enemy rally.** Only return during a confirmed calm window called by R5.

Holding the castle is not automatic after the wave takes it. The garrison must be actively managed. This is an R4 responsibility.

R4 Ongoing Duties

1. **Monitor hero order** — only the first 4 joining heroes affect garrison stats. Audit top-4 slots regularly.
2. **Verify hero talents** — switch from attack to defense hero setup immediately after seizing the castle. See formation sections below.
3. **Watch troop composition** — formation ratio must match the one called by R4 based on scout intelligence.
4. **Set a 20-minute refresh timer** — the moment the castle is first captured, R4 sets a 20-minute reminder for light injury management.

Defense Formation 1 — 60/40/0 (Anti-Cavalry)

Use when: scout reports enemy is running **heavy cavalry in their attack rallies**.

Role	Heroes	Formation	Notes
Garrison Rally Leader	Alcar / Margot / Saul	60 / 40 / 0 (Inf / Cav / Arch)	No archers. Max infantry + cavalry to counter enemy cavalry-heavy rallies.
First 4 Joiners	Hilda or Saul	Match garrison leader	Best: 3x Hilda + 1x Saul or 4x Hilda. Saul stacks well with a Saul garrison leader.

Defense Formation 2 — 60/20/20 (Balanced Default)

Use when: enemy composition is mixed or unknown. This is the **default formation** — always use this if the scout has not reported.

Role	Heroes	Formation	Notes
Garrison Rally Leader	Alcar or Long Fei Margot Vivien or Jaeger	60 / 20 / 20 (Inf / Cav / Arch)	Well-rounded against mixed attack compositions. Long Fei and Jaeger are strong if Alcar unavailable.
First 4 Joiners	Hilda or Saul	Match garrison leader	Best: 3x Hilda + 1x Saul or 4x Hilda. Do NOT put attack heroes in the first 4 defense slots.

Reassignment Tactic — Reset Hero Order

- Step 1 — Temporarily assign a placeholder player as rally captain.
- Step 2 — Immediately reassign the primary rally leader to the same position.
- Step 3 — System recalculates the First 4 slots. Prioritize strongest defenders.

Synchronization Swap — Rotate Heroes Without Gaps

How to switch hero lineups without leaving the garrison undefended:

1. Open building menu > **Garrison view** > tap **Dispatch Troops**.
2. Select new hero formation and troop composition > tap **Deploy**.
3. Monitor the new march approaching. Exactly **5 seconds before arrival**, recall the existing march.
4. Defense gap is virtually nonexistent.

Light Injury Refresh — 20-Minute Schedule

LIGHT INJURY WARNING: Lightly injured troops accumulate silently in a garrison and do NOT heal in hospital. They only recover when you FULLY WITHDRAW your march from the building. Ignoring this silently degrades your garrison even when troop counts look fine.

Protocol: Every 20 minutes of holding the castle, the R4 coordinates a garrison refresh:

1. Confirm a replacement march is ready and dispatched.
2. Recall the garrison at the moment the replacement march arrives (Synchronization Swap).
3. R4 sets the next 20-minute reminder immediately.

The wave strategy only works if wounded troops return to the front line quickly. When troops are knocked out or fail a rally, one-third go to the Infirmary. The goal is to get them back using Batch Healing — instantly, with no speed-ups spent.

Healing Priority Order

PRIORITY: Healing priority order: (1) Wave rally leaders → (2) Group 2 counter-rally leaders → (3) Filler players → (4) Solo attackers. R4 calls 'Wave leaders batch heal NOW' immediately after every wave exchange. Rally leaders are the bottleneck for the next cycle.

Your Personal Batch Size — Calculate Before the Battle

Batch size is **different for every player** based on their Embassy level. Do not rely on the example number — find your own.

1. Go to your Embassy > Building Overview > find **Healing Amount per Help**.
2. Count the number of active alliance members providing Auto-Help right now.
3. Multiply: **(Healing per Help) x (Active helpers) = your batch size**.
4. Use **Sheet 3 of the Calculators workbook** to record your number and have it ready during the battle.

Step	Action	Detail
1 — Check Embassy	Find Healing Amount per Help	Embassy > Building Overview > Healing Amount per Help
2 — Count helpers	Count active Auto-Help players	More online players = larger batch size
3 — Calculate	(Healing per Help) x (Helpers)	Example: 97 x 10 = 970. Your number will differ.
4 — Initiate	Select EXACTLY that number in Hospital	Auto-Help resolves it instantly — no speed-ups
5 — Repeat	Send healed troops back immediately	Start the next batch without delay

If your alliance lacks Ultra Value Monthly Card holders, **recruit farm accounts** to increase Auto-Help count and batch size.

RULE: Never let the Hospital overflow — overflowing troops are permanently lost. Batch heal continuously, not just at the end.

Quick Reference with R4 Voice Calls & Common Mistakes

Wave Strategy Quick Reference

What	Answer	R4 Voice Call
Wave 1 launch time	T + 0:00 — strongest leaders, castle capture	'5-4-3-2-1 — Wave 1 go'
Wave 2 launch time	T + 0:15 — intercept counter; refill castle	'5-4-3-2-1 — Wave 2 go'
Wave 3 launch time	T + 0:30 — fresh troops, seal the hold	'5-4-3-2-1 — Wave 3 go'
Cancel Wave 2 or 3?	Do NOT cancel same-alliance waves. Only cancel if confirmed friendly fire risk.	'Hold Wave 2' (only if needed)
5-minute gap rule	All non-leaders solo attack continuously. Leaders batch heal. Min 60% fill before next cycle.	'Everyone solo attack'
Turret launch	Post-castle only. All leaders except Yensid and Group 2 go to their turret immediately.	'Castle held — turrets go'
Attack first-4 joiners	2x Chenko + 2x Amane	Check before joining — no exceptions
Attack formation	50/20/30 or 50/10/40 — always match the rally leader	'Check formation NOW'

Counter Strategy Quick Reference

What	Answer	R4 Voice Call
When does Group 2 move?	Immediately after Wave 1 captures the castle — do not wait for an enemy attack	'Castle held — Group 2 move NOW'
Group 2 launch timing	AFTER enemy rally clears. Use Sheet 2 delay formula. Never before.	'Group 2 — release now'
If enemy rally fails?	Cancel Group 2 immediately — castle still held, no troops wasted	'Cancel Group 2 — hold'
If enemy takes castle?	Group 2 counter lands in seconds — enemy occupation 20-40 sec max	Counter launches on pre-staged release
When does Group 2 hand back?	When Group 1 rally leader is ~10 sec away — R4 calls withdraw	'Withdraw in 10-9-8...'
Group 2 re-stage time	Under 90 seconds. Group 3 covers if Group 2 is still healing.	'Group 2 re-stage'
Defense first-4 joiners	Saul or Hilda (3x Hilda + 1x Saul, or 4x Hilda)	'Defense heroes only in first 4'
Formation default	60/20/20 unless scout calls 60/40/0 (heavy cavalry)	'60/20/20 default'

Common Mistakes

Mistake	Why It's Dangerous	Fix
#1: Group 2 launches before enemy rally arrives	Same-kingdom fight — enemy gets a free win. Most catastrophic and most common mistake in the strategy.	Group 2 R4 verbally confirms 'enemy rally in flight' before releasing counter. If any doubt — hold.
Not moving Group 2 to second alliance immediately	Loses the entire pre-positioned counter advantage — back to 5-minute waits.	Group 2 moves the moment Yensid calls 'castle held'. Not after. Not when convenient.

Mistake	Why It's Dangerous	Fix
Underfilled rally	Loses almost every engagement against a defended castle.	R4 checks Sheet 4 fill tracker before calling every launch. Minimum 6 fillers.
Wrong hero in first-4 garrison	Heroes 5-8 have zero stat impact — garrison is silently much weaker than it looks.	Use Reassignment Tactic immediately if R4 spots out-of-order heroes.
Cancelling Wave 2 or 3 from same alliance	Removes pressure and wastes the pre-staged rally advantage.	Only cancel if there is confirmed friendly fire risk. Otherwise let all same-alliance waves run.
Using attack heroes in defense garrison post-capture	Massively reduces garrison defense after capture — often the cause of instantly losing the castle back.	Execute post-capture switch within 5 seconds of 'castle held' call using Synchronization Swap.
Ignoring light injuries	Garrison silently weakens over 20+ minutes despite full troop count.	R4 sets 20-minute refresh reminder at the moment of first capture. Mandatory.
Device clock vs server time	Mistimed arrivals break synchronization — 2-5 sec off is enough.	Use in-game server clock on the pre-rally screen only.
Hospital overflow	Troops permanently lost.	Batch heal continuously. Use Sheet 3 batch calculator for your personal batch size.

Two pillars. Every element in this guide exists to make one of them stronger. The Calculators workbook handles all timing math so R4 can focus on commanding, not calculating.